

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

ServiceNow Micro-Project

PHASE 2 | REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS PHASE

2. Requirement Analysis Phase

2.1 Purpose

This phase converts the ideation outcome from Phase 1 into a concrete set of functional and non-functional requirements for the automated Standard Laptop procurement flow, covering the objectives stated in the project brief.

2.2 Project Objective (from brief)

Implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

2.3 Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Interest / Role
End user / Requester	Orders a Standard Laptop through the Service Catalog and expects timely configuration and delivery.
Approver	Reviews and approves the laptop request before fulfillment begins.
Hardware Team	Receives the auto-generated Catalog Task and performs the physical configuration of the laptop.
IT Procurement Team	Owns the catalog item and the automation; wants reduced manual overhead.
ServiceNow Platform (Flow Designer)	Executes the automation reliably upon each qualifying request.

2.4 Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement
FR-01	The system shall provide a Flow named "Standard Laptop task", scoped to the Global application, running as the System User.
FR-02	The Flow shall be triggered by the Service Catalog trigger whenever a request is created against the associated catalog item.
FR-03	The Flow shall use the "Create Catalog Task" action to generate a Catalog Task (sc_task) record from the Requested Item.
FR-04	The generated Catalog Task shall have Short Description = "Laptop needs to Configured".
FR-05	The generated Catalog Task shall have Description field value = "Laptop needs to Configured".
FR-06	The generated Catalog Task shall have Assignment group = "Hardware".
FR-07	The generated Catalog Task shall have Approval = "Approved".
FR-08	The Flow shall be published (Active) so it executes on real transactions.
FR-09	The "Standard Laptop" catalog item's Process Engine shall reference this Flow (not a legacy Workflow or Execution Plan).
FR-10	The system shall allow an end user to browse the Service Catalog → Hardware category, open "Standard Laptop", and click "Order Now" to submit a request.
FR-11	The system shall allow an approver to review and Approve the request from the Approvers related list on the Request record.
FR-12	Once approved, the auto-created Catalog Task shall be visible under the Requested Item's "Catalog Tasks" related list, correctly assigned to the Hardware group.

2.5 Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Requirement
NFR-01	Reliability: The flow must trigger consistently for every Standard Laptop request without manual re-triggering.
NFR-02	Timeliness: The Catalog Task must be created immediately following approval, minimizing user wait time.
NFR-03	Maintainability: The flow should use built-in, documented actions (Create Catalog Task) rather than custom scripts, so non-developers can maintain it.
NFR-04	Traceability: Every generated task must be linked back to its Requested Item (RITM) for audit purposes.
NFR-05	Reusability: The flow pattern should be easy to replicate for other standard catalog items in the future.

2.6 Assumptions

- The "Standard Laptop" catalog item already exists under Service Catalog → Hardware.
- A "Hardware" assignment group already exists and is available for task assignment.
- The approver for the demo request is a valid ServiceNow user able to action the Approvers related list.

2.7 Constraints

- Flow Designer requires the flow to be explicitly Activated before it executes on live transactions.
- The catalog item's Process Engine can only reference one automation type at a time (Flow, Workflow, or Execution Plan) — any pre-existing automation must be removed before adding the new Flow.
- The project is scoped only to the "standard, pre-configured" laptop order path; custom/non-standard requests are out of scope.

2.8 Tools & Environment

Component	Detail
Platform	ServiceNow (Application Scope: Global)
Modules used	Flow Designer (Process Automation), Service Catalog, Maintain Items, Catalog Tasks
Trigger type	Service Catalog trigger
Core action	Create Catalog Task (ServiceNow Core spoke)
Verification method	End-to-end order placement, approval, and task review as an end user / approver

The requirement analysis confirms that a single Service-Catalog-triggered Flow, using the built-in "Create Catalog Task" action with pre-filled description, assignment group and approval fields, fully satisfies the automation objective set out in the project brief.